



iGamer

Ok there's no such thing as iGamer, we've made it up. But what else would you call this whole new breed of gamers

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Is the average age of the most frequent game purchaser according to a 2011 report published by the Entertainment Software Association. Of the most frequent game purchasers, 52% are male and 48% are, hold your breath... female! Women age 18 or older represent a significantly greater portion of the game-playing population (37%) than boys aged 17 or younger (13%)

who have emerged thanks to the iOS platform? The portable gaming industry was initially dominated by Gameboys, Nintendo's DS, PSP and the ilk. But with powerful hardware coming in phones developers soon realised that phones and tablets are very viable gaming devices. Utilising hardware such as gyroscopes these games provided gamers with newer experiences. Besides, getting your hands on new games was simply a download away.



Ongamenet

No it's not some weird Japanese PrOn. Try to break it up and pronounce it; "On Game Net". That's it. OGN is a TV



channel in Korea that shows StarCraft matches all the time. Well maybe not all the time, but having a channel dedicated to showcasing videogame matches is quite something. And showcasing just StarCraft is downright insane and freakin cool! Man those crazy Koreans; now all we need is a visa!



FPS

Looking at the world through the aiming reticle of an assault rifle has been, and will always be every young



boy's waking dream. Right from Wolfenstein 3D, the First Person Shooter genre became a rage and later on spawned an entire generation of gamers who lived for frags. Every year we see several FPS releases with game designers trying to redefine this old favourite genre. But despite several embellishments towards realism and game-play at its core it remains the same; power ups, health, big f**kin guns and kills.



Playstation

With its Playstation line, Sony has been at the forefront of innovation in the console space. PS was the console that popularised the CD format of digital distribution, and the PS2 is the world's largest selling console with over 150 million units in circulation, and popularised the use of DVDs. The PS3 did the same thing for Blu-ray. Yes troubles with PSN (Play Station Network) off late have tarnished its former glory, but PlayStation still remains a strong name in the console space, with all eyes currently on the PlayStation Vita, the next version of the PSP handheld.



SecondLife

Second Life lets you explore a mirror world in virtual reality where you can do many of

things you do in real life – buy crap, be broke, get married, pick fights, get bullied, attend concerts, et al. Wait a minute, don't you do these things in real life anyway? So why would you want to do them all over again in cyber space?! Beats us. We can understand the gold rush post the initial hype, and yet thousands of people still flock to this once multi-player game and now a virtual chat room of sorts. Why does it feature here then? For it being the precursor to a new step in gaming. Even today specific islands do host customised role-playing games in this ghost-town of a virtual world. *Second Life* could very well be a fledgling step into a form of gaming that is yet to be fully exploited and explored.



Zynga

Don't scoff at us for saying this, but all those OCD afflicted procrastinators of work who spend endless hours on social games - expanding their Mafia gangs, enlisting Vampires, and irrigating their farms - are also gamers. Gamers of a different kind but gamers nonetheless. And this new breed has come into existence purely on account of seminal work in social gaming by a small startup called Zynga. Starting off with the limited success of Poker, the company now has 200 million monthly active users, with games such as Farmville. Shocking.

